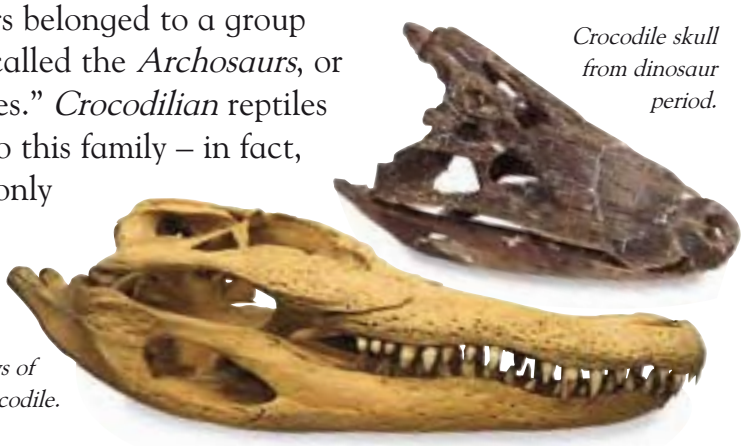
Ancient reptiles

The dinosaurs belonged to a group of creatures called the *Archosaurs*, or "ruling reptiles." *Crocodilian* reptiles also belong to this family – in fact, they are the only *Archosaurs* still alive.



Crocodile skull from dinosaur period.

Skull and jaws of a modern crocodile.

Reptile file

- Croc mothers lay between 10 and 90 eggs at a time.
- The largest crocs can grow to more than 23 ft (7 m) long.
- Adult crocs swallow rocks to help them break up (digest) their food.
- Some crocodiles can live for up to 100 years.



Dwarf of the riverbank

Dwarf crocodiles are the smallest species of croc, and grow to just 6.5 ft (2 m) long. They are shy, secretive animals that hide away in riverbank holes when in danger.

Dwarf crocodile

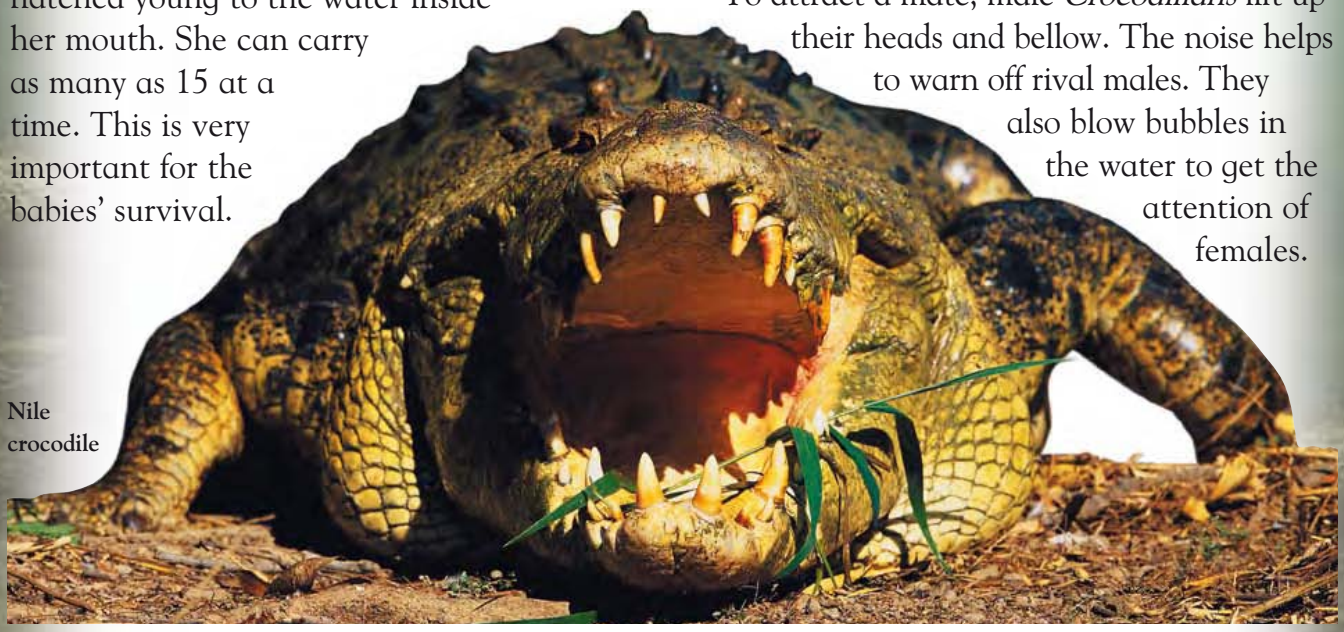


Careful crocs

A female croc carries her newly hatched young to the water inside her mouth. She can carry as many as 15 at a time. This is very important for the babies' survival.

Croc courtship

To attract a mate, male *Crocodilians* lift up their heads and bellow. The noise helps to warn off rival males. They also blow bubbles in the water to get the attention of females.



Nile crocodile